



Northstar Analytics Information Security and Acceptable Use Policy

Requirements for protecting systems data accounts devices and communications

Policy owner	Information Security	Version	1.0
Effective date	September 26 2026	Applies to	Workforce and authorized users

1 Purpose and Scope

Northstar Analytics protects company, employee, and client information by requiring secure and responsible use of technology resources. This policy applies to employees, contractors, temporary workers, interns, vendors, and other authorized users who access Northstar systems, accounts, networks, devices, applications, or data, whether company-owned or personally owned.

Users must protect information according to its sensitivity, use resources primarily for legitimate business, and report suspected security events immediately. More restrictive legal, regulatory, contractual, client, or data-owner requirements control when they conflict with this policy.

2 Core Security Responsibilities

- **Protect access.** Keep credentials and authentication devices private, use multifactor authentication, and approve only sign-in prompts that you initiated.
- **Protect information.** Access, use, share, retain, and dispose of data only for authorized business purposes and according to its classification.
- **Protect equipment.** Secure devices from loss, theft, damage, unauthorized use, and observation; keep required security controls enabled.
- **Report promptly.** Immediately report suspicious messages, lost devices, misdirected data, unauthorized access, malware, or other suspected incidents.

3 Acceptable Use

Northstar resources may be used for authorized work, professional development, approved collaboration, and limited incidental personal activity that is lawful, reasonable, secure, and does not interfere with work, create material cost, consume excessive capacity, or harm Northstar or its clients. Incidental use does not make personal content private or require Northstar to preserve it.

Users must communicate professionally, preserve required business records in approved repositories, follow software licenses and intellectual-property rights, and obtain approval before representing Northstar publicly or committing company resources.

4 Identity and Access Management

Each user is accountable for activity performed through assigned accounts. Shared accounts are prohibited unless Information Security approves and controls them for a documented business need. Users must not disclose passwords, security answers, recovery codes, access tokens, private keys, or one-time codes; reuse company credentials on personal services; or bypass access controls.

Access is granted on least-privilege and need-to-know principles. Users must complete required access reviews, promptly report unnecessary or incorrect access, and stop using access when duties change. Managers and system owners must request timely changes when a worker transfers, takes extended leave, or separates.

5 Devices Software and Networks

- **Approved devices.** Use company-managed devices for company work unless an approved bring-your-own-device arrangement permits otherwise.
- **Security configuration.** Do not disable encryption, endpoint protection, screen locking, logging, updates, mobile-device management, or other required controls.
- **Software and services.** Install or use only approved software, browser extensions, cloud services, storage, messaging tools, and integrations.
- **Network use.** Use approved secure access methods. Avoid untrusted public networks; when unavoidable, use the company-approved secure connection and protect the screen from observation.
- **Physical security.** Keep devices attended or locked, do not leave them visible in vehicles, and promptly return company property when requested.

6 Data Handling and Communications

Users must follow the Data Classification and Handling Standard. Company and client data may be stored, processed, transmitted, printed, copied, or shared only through approved locations and methods. Sensitive data must be encrypted as required, limited to authorized recipients, verified before sending, and securely destroyed when retention ends.

Do not send company information to personal accounts, store it on personal media, upload it to unapproved services, or discuss it where unauthorized people can hear. External sharing must have a business purpose, appropriate permission, the minimum necessary data, and any required contractual safeguards. Users must preserve records subject to retention schedules, investigations, audits, or legal holds.

7 Prohibited Activities

- **Unauthorized access.** Attempting to view, alter, test, intercept, or disrupt systems, accounts, networks, or data without written authorization.
- **Security evasion.** Circumventing controls, concealing activity, disabling logs, scanning without approval, or introducing malware or unauthorized tools.
- **Harmful or unlawful use.** Harassment, discrimination, threats, fraud, illegal activity, copyright infringement, gambling, or accessing or distributing obscene or abusive material.
- **Improper commercial use.** Outside business, political campaigning, solicitation, cryptocurrency mining, or excessive personal use without authorization.
- **Unapproved disclosure.** Posting confidential information, source code, credentials, client details, or internal communications to public sites or external tools.

8 Remote Mobile Third Party and AI Use

Remote and mobile work must follow the Remote and Hybrid Work Policy and International Remote Work Policy. Users must maintain private workspaces, prevent household or public access, and avoid local printing or storage of sensitive information unless approved. Vendors and external collaborators receive only the access and data necessary for approved work and must meet Northstar security requirements.

Do not enter confidential, personal, regulated, client, source-code, credential, or proprietary information into public or unapproved artificial intelligence tools. Approved AI use must follow data classification, client restrictions, intellectual-property requirements, human review expectations, and any designated AI governance procedures.

9 Monitoring Privacy and Records

Users should not expect personal privacy when using Northstar systems, accounts, networks, or devices. Subject to applicable law, Northstar may log, access, preserve, inspect, monitor, or disclose company resources for security, support, business continuity, records management, investigations, legal compliance, and protection of rights or property. Monitoring will be proportionate to legitimate business needs and handled by authorized personnel.

10 Security Incident Reporting

Immediately report suspected phishing, credential compromise, malware, unauthorized access, data loss or exposure, unusual system behavior, accidental disclosure, and lost, stolen, searched, or seized devices to Information Security. If possible, disconnect an affected device from the network without powering it off, preserve messages and evidence, and follow response instructions. Do not investigate independently, contact an attacker, erase data, or notify affected parties unless authorized.

Urgent threats to personal safety should be reported to emergency services first. Users must cooperate with containment, evidence preservation, password resets, client notification, legal review, and corrective actions under the Security Incident Reporting Procedure.

11 Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
All users	Follow this policy, complete training, protect credentials and data, use approved resources, and report incidents immediately.
Managers	Confirm appropriate access, reinforce secure practices, escalate concerns, and request access changes when roles or employment status change.
System and data owners	Approve access, define handling requirements, review permissions, retain records, and address identified risks.
Information Security	Maintain safeguards, standards, awareness, monitoring, risk reviews, incident response, and security exceptions.
People Operations and Legal	Support investigations, workforce actions, privacy and legal reviews, record holds, and consistent enforcement.

12 Exceptions Enforcement and Reporting

Exceptions require a documented business need, risk assessment, compensating controls, owner approval, Information Security approval, and an expiration or review date. No manager or client may waive this policy informally. Northstar may suspend access immediately when necessary to protect systems, data, people, or clients.

Violations may result in access restriction, corrective action, contract remedies, legal action, or separation, consistent with applicable law and agreements. Northstar prohibits retaliation for good-faith reporting of security, privacy, legal, or ethical concerns. Reports may be made to Information Security, a manager, People Operations, or Legal.

13 Related Documents

Employee Handbook; Data Classification and Handling Standard; Security Incident Reporting Procedure; Company Equipment Lifecycle Policy and Procedures; Remote and Hybrid Work Policy; International Remote Work Policy; Access Control and Identity Management Procedure; Records Retention Policy; Workplace Conduct and Professional Standards; Workplace Concern and HR Case Procedure.